

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #2416

Name
Spencer Weinstein
Email
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Gender
Female
City, state, and country of residence
Kitchener, Ontario, Canada
Nationality
USA
When did or will you finish your PhD?
August 2023
University Education
PhD Biology University of Waterloo Expected August 2023
M.S. Biology Texas Christian University May 2018
B.S. Natural Resources Conservation University of Massachusetts, Amherst May 2016
B.A. Geography University of Massachusetts, Amherst May 2016
What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?
I am eager to serve as a Science Corps fellow because I believe that one of the most important things I can do as a scientist is to empower the next generation of scientists, and specifically youth who may be discouraged from science for various reasons. I had never met a scientist prior to university, and there have been several times when I questioned my path; those experiences helped me realize the importance of engaging with students and making science seem more approachable. I also love doing youth science outreach and education, and seeing their excitement, and I think serving as a Science Corps fellow will allow me to expand my science communication and teaching repertoire, especially as I narrow down exactly what path I hope to be on for my future career. Personally, I am excited to explore a new location and to work in a new place and culture; I am eager from a break from academia that still allows me to make use of the skills I have developed throughout grad school. I first learned about Science Corps shortly after it was started, and ever since I have been excitedly waiting for my opportunity to apply.
In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

I am passionate about science outreach and communication, and I recognize the need to build community capacity in research so that community members can spearhead research that matters to them. During my PhD, I have worked in a community with a different culture to my own, and I have become skilled at adapting scientific norms and expectations to accommodate local values. I have also worked with community members of all ages, including children who eagerly assist me with sampling whenever possible; I have taught them about fish, effects of climate change, and sampling methods, and recognizing that building capacity requires a reciprocal relationship, I have learned from them about their experiences fishing. I have also been involved with organizations such as Letters to a Pre-Scientist and Skype a Scientist, and have completed a two year scientific communications program through the American Fisheries Society. All of these activities have helped prepare me for a Science Corps fellowship. I have a realistic view of the challenges of working in different cultural contexts, but I also know what can be achieved with mutual trust and respect. I also have extensive international travel experience, and am skilled at adapting to different cultures and environments.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
Doing science in industry
In science education
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In the short-term, I hope to complete a post-doc expanding on my PhD research on char diversity and subsistence fishing in the Canadian Arctic. I am passionate about community-partnered and mixed-methods research, and there are several research questions building on my PhD work that I am eager to answer. Given the importance of community in my research, and that I aim to incorporate multiple knowledge systems and ways of knowing into my work, science outreach and education are more or less built in to my every day work. In the long-term, I hope to have my own research lab and work to address fisheries conservation questions that matter to fishing communities. I plan to continue working to build community capacity so that community members with deep connections to the land but who do not necessarily have formal scientific training can, with support from scientists, lead their own research projects.

CV/Resume

 [CV_Nov2022_SYW.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

EvoDir

Any other comments/questions?

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